EXECUTIVE SUMMARY REPORT

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This analysis evaluates the sales and profitability performance of a retail business using the Sample - Superstore transactional dataset. The objective is to provide management with an interactive view of overall performance, regional performance, customer segments, product categories, product profitability, and sales trends over time.

The dataset contains 9,994 transaction records covering January 2014 to December 2017. The analysis was conducted using Power BI following data inspection, cleaning, transformation, modelling, and KPI development.

Overall, the business generated approximately $2.30 million in sales and $286.40 thousand in profit, with 5,009 unique orders and an overall profit margin of 12.47%.

KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

KPI	RESULTS
Total Sales	$2,297,200
Total Profit	$286,397
Total Orders	5,009
Average Sales per Order	$458.61
Profit Margin	12.47%

KEY BUSINESS FINDINGS

1. **Regional Performance**

The West region generated the highest sales at approximately $725,457, followed by the East at $678,781. The West also generated the highest profit at approximately $108,418.

The South region recorded the lowest sales at approximately $391,721, while the Central region generated approximately $501,239 in sales.

This indicates a significant difference in performance between regions and provides an opportunity to investigate the factors contributing to stronger performance in the West and East.

2. **Customer Segment Performance**

The Consumer segment contributed the largest share of revenue, generating approximately $1.16 million in sales and $134,119 in profit.

The Corporate segment generated approximately $706,146 in sales, while Home Office generated approximately $429,653.

Consumer customers represent the largest revenue base and should remain an important focus of customer retention and sales strategies.

3. **Product Category Performance**

Technology generated the highest sales among the three categories, with approximately $836,154 in sales and $145,454 in profit.

Office Supplies generated approximately $719,047 in sales and $122,490 in profit, while Furniture generated approximately $742,000 in sales but only $18,451 in profit.

The difference between Furniture's sales contribution and its relatively low profit indicates that high sales volume does not necessarily translate into strong profitability.

4. **Product Profitability**

The Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier was the most profitable individual product in the dataset, generating approximately $25,199 in profit.

Other highly profitable products included:

- Fellowes PB500 Electric Punch Plastic Comb Binding Machine
- Hewlett Packard LaserJet 3310 Copier
- Canon PC1060 Personal Laser Copier
- HP Designjet T520 Inkjet Large Format Printer

5. **Performance Over Time**

Sales and profit generally increased over the four-year period.

Year	**Sales**	**Profit**
2014	$484,247	$49,543
2015	$470,532	$61,618
2016	$609,205	$81,795
2017	$733,215	$93,439

The strongest year was **2017**, which recorded the highest sales and profit in the dataset.

BUSINESS RISKS

1. **Low Profitability in Furniture**

Furniture generated approximately $742,000 in sales but only $18,451 in profit, substantially below Technology despite having a comparable sales contribution.

2. **Regional Performance Imbalance**

The substantial difference between the highest-performing West region and lower-performing regions indicates that business performance is not evenly distributed geographically.

3. **Negative-Profit Transactions**

The dataset contains 1,871 transaction lines with negative profit. These transactions should be investigated to determine whether discounting, product costs, shipping costs, or specific product/customer combinations are contributing to losses.

BUSINESS OPPORTUNITIES

1. **Expand High-Performing Technology Products**

Technology generates the highest category profit and sales. Management can investigate opportunities to expand sales of high-performing technology products and related offerings.

2. **Improve Furniture Profitability**

Furniture represents a significant sales category but generates relatively low profit. Reviewing pricing, discounts, product costs, and product mix could provide an opportunity to improve margins.

3. **Strengthen High-Performing Regional Markets**

The strong performance of the West and East regions provides an opportunity to identify successful sales practices and assess whether similar strategies can be applied to lower-performing regions.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Review Furniture pricing, discounting, and product costs to identify the main causes of low profitability.
2. Prioritize high-profit Technology products in sales planning, promotional activities, and inventory decisions.
3. Investigate negative-profit transactions to identify products, regions, customers, or discount levels associated with recurring losses.
4. Analyse the sales practices used in the West and East regions and assess whether successful approaches can be replicated in lower-performing regions.
5. Develop targeted strategies for the Consumer segment, which represents the largest revenue and profit contribution.
6. Monitor profitability alongside sales, rather than relying on revenue alone when evaluating product and regional performance.

CONCLUSION

The analysis indicates that the business is experiencing overall growth, with 2017 recording the highest sales and profit during the period analysed. Technology is the strongest product category by profit, while the West is the strongest region by both sales and profit. The Consumer segment represents the largest customer contribution.

The Power BI dashboard provides an interactive platform for monitoring these areas and enables management to filter performance by year, region, customer segment, and product category to support further investigation and decision-making.